06-17 第二篇

The Growing and Trade of Cotton

Cotton is one of the most important crops in the world. It has been used for thousands of years to make cloth, and today it is still the main material for many of our clothes and household items. [1] In other words, cotton plays a central role in both history and modern life. Understanding how cotton is grown and traded helps us see how a simple plant connects farmers, factories, and people everywhere.

Cotton needs warm weather and plenty of sunshine to grow well. [2] Farmers usually plant cotton in spring and harvest it in autumn when the white, fluffy bolls（棉铃）open. The crop requires a lot of water, so many cotton farms are found in areas with rainfall or irrigation systems. Farmers must also control pests and weeds, which can damage the plants. In some places, farmers use natural methods or organic practices to reduce the use of chemicals. Once the cotton is picked, it is cleaned and the seeds are removed before the fibres are ready for spinning into thread.

The journey from field to fabric involves many steps. [3] After harvesting, cotton is often sent to factories where machines separate the fibres from the seeds and spin them into yarn. The yarn is then woven or knitted into cloth, which can be dyed and made into clothes, towels, and other products. This process takes place in many countries around the world—some grow the cotton, others spin and weave it, and still others design and sell the final products. The global cotton trade connects millions of people across continents.

Cotton farming and trade have both benefits and challenges. [4] Cotton provides income for millions of farmers and workers, especially in developing countries. However, growing cotton can use large amounts of water and pesticides, which may harm the environment. Some organisations now promote sustainable cotton—grown with less water and fewer chemicals—to reduce this impact. Fair trade practices aim to ensure that farmers receive a fair price for their crop and that workers are treated well.

[5] Cotton remains a vital part of human life and the global economy. By choosing sustainable and fairly traded cotton when we can, we support farmers and help protect the environment. The next time you put on a cotton T-shirt or use a cotton towel, remember the long journey from seed to shelf—and the many hands that made it possible.

选项

A. In other words, cotton is central to both history and modern life around the world. B. They plant in spring, harvest in autumn when bolls open, and must provide water and

control pests. C. In fact, cotton travels from farms to factories where it is spun into yarn and made into cloth and products. D. These facts show that cotton brings both economic benefits and environmental challenges that need attention. E. In short, cotton is vital to human life and we can support sustainability by choosing better cotton products. F. For example, China and India are among the largest producers of cotton in the world.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：概括棉花的地位与意义。空前描述"Cotton one of most important crops...used thousands of years...main material for clothes and household items"，空后说明"cotton plays central role in both history and modern life...Understanding...helps see how simple plant connects farmers, factories, people everywhere"。A选项"In other words, cotton is central to both history and modern life around the world"（换言之，棉花在历史和现代生活中都具有核心地位）中"In other words"概括空前，"central to history and modern life"与空后"central role in both history and modern life"精准呼应，衔接顺畅。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：棉花的种植与采收流程。空前提出"Cotton needs warm weather and plenty of sunshine to grow well"，空后详述"Farmers plant in spring, harvest in autumn when white fluffy bolls open...needs lot of water...farms in areas with rainfall or irrigation...control pests and weeds...some use natural or organic methods...picked, cleaned, seeds removed...fibres ready for spinning"。B选项"They plant in spring, harvest in autumn when bolls open, and must provide water and control pests"（他们在春季播种，棉铃开放时秋季采收，并需提供水源与控制害虫）中"plant in spring, harvest in autumn when bolls open...water...control pests"与空后各项农事完美对应，逻辑紧密。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：棉花从田间到织物的加工链条。空前提出"The journey from field to fabric involves many steps"，空后列举"Sent to factories...machines separate fibres from seeds, spin into yarn...yarn woven or knitted into cloth...dyed...made into clothes, towels...process in many countries...some grow, others spin and weave, others design and sell...global trade connects millions across continents"。C选项"In fact, cotton travels from farms to factories where it is spun into yarn and made into cloth and products"（事实上，棉花从农场运到工

厂，在那里纺成纱并制成布料和产品）中"In fact"强化加工流程，"travels from farms to factories...spun into yarn...cloth and products"与空后 sent to factories、spin、woven、cloth、products 精准对应，衔接自然。

- [4] D：
  - **线索**：棉花产业的经济与环保双重影响。空前提出"Cotton farming and trade have both benefits and challenges"，空后描述"Income for millions of farmers and workers...developing countries...growing uses large amounts water and pesticides...may harm environment...sustainable cotton...less water, fewer chemicals...fair trade...fair price, workers treated well"。D选项"These facts show that cotton brings both economic benefits and environmental challenges that need attention"（这些事实表明棉花既带来经济益处，也存在需要关注的环境挑战）中"These facts"指代空后利弊，"economic benefits...environmental challenges"与空后 income、water and pesticides、sustainable 完美对应，衔接得当。
- [5] E：
  - **线索**：全文收束与可持续消费倡议。空[5]位于结尾段段首，空后总结"Cotton remains vital part of human life and global economy...choosing sustainable and fairly traded cotton...support farmers, protect environment...next time cotton T-shirt or towel...remember long journey...many hands made it possible"。E选项"In short, cotton is vital to human life and we can support sustainability by choosing better cotton products"（简言之，棉花对人类生活至关重要，我们可通过选择更优棉制品来支持可持续）用"In short"总结全文，"vital...support sustainability...choosing better cotton"与空后"vital...sustainable and fairly traded...support farmers"形成呼应，收束精准。
- **干扰项分析**：
  - **F. For example, China and India are among the largest producers of cotton in the world.**：涉及中印为产棉大国，易被误填[3]或[4]。但F以"For example"引出产棉国，而空[3]讨论的是棉花加工与全球产业链，F的"producers"属于种植端，与"factories...spun...woven...many countries"的加工与贸易焦点不同；空[4]讨论经济与环保双重影响，F的产棉国列举与"benefits and challenges"的利弊分析层次不符。F属"主题相关但论述层次错位"型干扰。